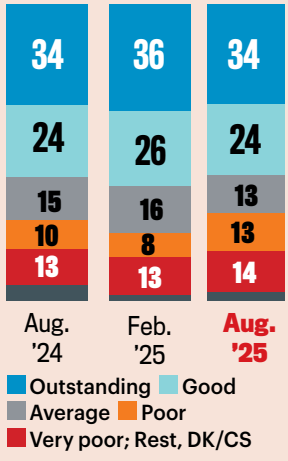
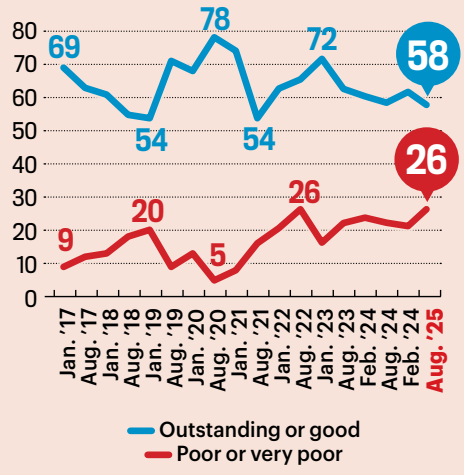
Q. How do you rate the performance of Narendra Modi as prime minister?



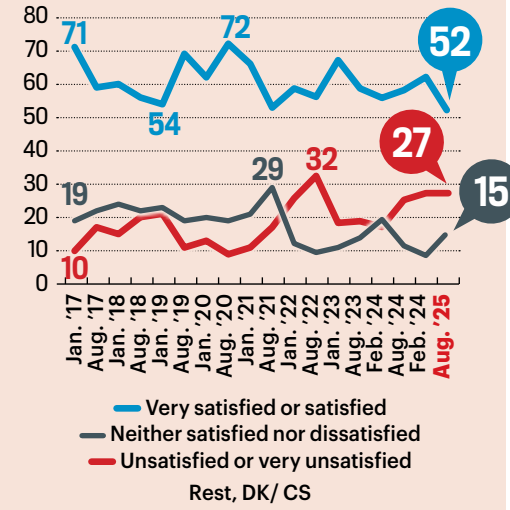
Approval for PM Narendra Modi remains almost constant since he took charge in his third term

MODI'S PERFORMANCE ACROSS MOTNs



Support for Modi shows long-term decline–it was over 70 per cent in 2021 and has slipped below 60 per cent now

Q. How satisfied are you with the overall performance of the NDA government?



There is a 10 point dent in public satisfaction with the NDA govt's overall performance since February

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ can't say

53 per cent in August 2016. The BJP's seat tally likewise rose to 305 from 259.

Again, in 2019, four months before the general election, the January MOTN poll showed a sharp dip in Modi's ratings and a drop in BJP's seat tally to 202, as much as 70 short of a simple majority on its own. The next month, however, saw a suicide bomber blow up a CRPF van in Pulwama, killing 40 personnel. Modi ordered the Indian Air Force to carry out punitive air strikes in Balakot, deep inside Pakistan, which proved to be a game-changer in the general election held in May that year. Modi and the BJP swept to power again with an even bigger majority of 303 seats on their own and 353 for the NDA. That sentiment carried over into the August MOTN poll, too, that year, with Modi's performance rating of 'good' to 'outstanding' spiking from 54 per cent in January to 71 per cent seven months later.

This year, however, despite Operation Sindoor being an even stronger strike on Pakistan, which saw the headquarters of prominent terror groups located in the politically powerful Punjab province as well as air bases being bombed, there is no spike either in Modi's ratings or in Lok Sabha seat projections for the BJP. This is probably because while India won the battle, the Modi government seemingly lost bragging rights to the US. Especially as Trump repeated ad nauseam that he had brokered the ceasefire between India and Pakistan to avert a nuclear war. This contradicted India's assertion that it was Islamabad that begged Delhi for a ceasefire and not the US that brought it about.

THE MODI GOVERNMENT MAY HAVE WON THE BATTLE BUT IT LOST THE BRAGGING RIGHTS, WITH DONALD TRUMP GOING AD NAUSEAM ABOUT HOW HE HAD BROKERED PEACE

Who Stole the Narrative?

The MOTN poll reflects mixed public sentiment on how India handled the narrative. Nearly 55 per cent respondents regard Operation Sindoor as a strong response to the Pahalgam terror strike. But while 54 per cent believe that the Modi government provided truthful and transparent information about Operation Sindoor, almost 33 per cent, or a third, disagree. As for who the respondents thought orchestrated the ceasefire, a good 29 per cent